

Team Fortress 2

Valve sells Team Fortress 2 on Steam for Rs. 125 (\$2.5) for few hours during the Halloween weekend

DirectX 11

Unigine, the first ever DirectX 11 benchmark launches and is available on their site – www.unigine.com

Q&A

Digit at your service

From antivirus to overclocking, all your questions answered!

? Blue screen

I recently purchased a HP DV5-1106 AX laptop that came pre-loaded with Vista Basic. When I try to install Windows XP (SP3 integrated), a blue screen of death occurs and I am not able to do so. I think my notebook has a Hitachi SATA drive and there no option of switching the SATA

are readable on my laptop. Other DVDs can even be written perfectly. Please tell me if I have to buy a new writer or not.

Jignesh Lad

! There is most likely some kind of compatibility issue with your drive if it's really old. You should try flashing its firmware.



nLite allows integrating of SATA controllers drivers into the Windows installer

mode to IDE in BIOS. I couldn't find AMD ACHI/RAID 0 drivers anywhere. What should I do to install Windows XP?

Pranav Kumar

! Without the SATA drivers integrated into your Windows installation disc, there is no way to install Windows to your laptop. Your hard drive won't be detected by the installer. You have to find drivers for the laptop on the driver disc or the manufacturer's site.

? DVD problems

I'm using an LG DVD writer. The problem is that Digit DVDs are not readable while other DVDs

Remember, this is a risky task. Usually, the firmware adds support for newer media. We suggest trying some more Digit DVDs to be sure.

? Few Queries

I recently bought a Compaq Notebook with the following configuration.

- AMD Athlon X2 QL65 2.1 GHz
- 3 GB DDR2 800 MHz memory
- ATI Mobility Radeon HD 3450 512 MB graphics card
- 320 GB hard drive with Windows 7 installed

My queries are as follows:

1. Can you suggest a good alternative for MS Office which is free as I just have

the trial version of MS Office installed. The features might not be as rich as MS Office 2007, but I want to be able to view and format PowerPoint presentations created on MS Office 2007.

2. Can I play games like FIFA 2010 or Ashes 2009 with the above configuration? If yes, suggest a good gaming pad for my PC within Rs. 1,500.
3. I want to buy a 320 GB portable hard drive. Which is the best buy within a budget of Rs. 3,000?
4. Also suggest a good noise isolating earphone within a budget of Rs. 2,000 for my PMP. I already have a Creative EP630.

Ashutosh

! OpenOffice is probably the best free MS Office alternative around. You can download it from <http://www.openoffice.org>.

FIFA 2010 and *Ashes 09* should just run fine on your configuration. You might have to reduce settings a bit. The Xbox360 wired controller is very popular these days and can be found for around Rs. 1,400 in major cities. Look for a WD My Passport 320 GB. It should be just around Rs. 3,000. The EP630 is already a good noise isolation earphone. There isn't anything a lot better for that price. The Creative EP830 might be one to look at.

? Booting issues

I have a Pentium 4 system (2.8 GHz HT processor, 1 GB DDR1

RAM, Intel 865GBF motherboard). I have a single OS - Windows XP (SP3) loaded on it. I have recently purchased an external USB hard drive (Seagate FreeAgent 1 TB), only to increase the storage capacity for my desktop.

However, whenever I switch on my computer with the hard drive connected to the USB port, the screen freezes at the Intel P4 screen and the OS does not boot at all. Without the hard drive connected during startup, the boot is normal.

I have disabled the USB booting option in the BIOS setup. Now when I switch on my computer, there are following two scenarios:

1. If I simply restart the PC, then the original problem still persists and the screen freezes at the initial Intel Pentium 4 logo.
2. If I shut down the system (including shutting down the power supply to the external HDD) and then start again, the system proceeds to boot, but there is a delay of almost a minute and the screen goes blank between the loading of the OS and appearance of the XP login screen.

I have undone the changes done in the BIOS setup and now I have to always physically disconnect the drive before bootup and then reconnect it. I would like my system to boot normally with the external hard drive always connected